

CANONICAL LESSON

Plan Seats Before Crowding Arrives

Decision-centred foundations for accountable sector intelligence

Production Unit	PU-B07-C39
Notebook	V7_C_N04
Status	Controlled educational draft v0.1
Data boundary	Synthetic instructional data only

Central decision: Plan school seats using demographic change, enrolment flows, accessibility, geography, uncertainty, cost, and accountable public authority.

Learning outcomes

Why this matters

Single-point forecasts can create stranded capacity, overcrowding, or unequal access when migration and uncertainty are ignored.

The analytical workflow is useful only when evidence, uncertainty, authority, and action are connected explicitly. The model supports professional judgement; it does not replace accountable institutional authority.

Worked cross-sector example

A planning team tests demand scenarios before expanding classrooms or changing catchment arrangements.

Boundary: The example supports learning and review. It does not constitute an official statistic, eligibility determination, enforcement action, clinical judgement, or operational authorization.

Practice and reflection

- 1.
- Add school-level accessibility.
- 2.
- Model construction lead time.
- 3.

- Explain why a surplus does not justify closure.

Answer key

- 1.
- Use travel time, safety, disability access, language, gender, and service availability.
- 2.
- Forecast demand at commissioning date and include land, design, procurement, construction, staffing, and maintenance gates.
- 3.
- Seats may be unusable, distant, mismatched by grade/shift, or needed for resilience and class-size goals.

Operational readiness checklist

- Purpose and decision owner are named.
- Evidence definitions, provenance, and lawful access are documented.
- Uncertainty and abstention are visible.
- Human review, escalation, monitoring, incident response, and retirement are assigned.
- Equity, accessibility, security, and sector-specific approval are complete.